



Sony SmartWatch

The Sony SmartWatch features an easy-to-use, ultra-responsive touch display.
<http://dgit.in/OPFR9a>



Chrome OS updates

The Chrome team updated Chrome OS for Chromebooks and the Chromebox recently.
<http://dgit.in/LR40xt>

Move over Rehab, Welcome to Wiihab!

We take a look at how regular gaming consoles, particularly the Wii, are finding a foothold in occupational therapy

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If you are given two choices – doing physical exercises or playing a gesture-based game which incorporates these same exercises – what would you choose? We asked this question to Team Digit, and the reply was unanimous – play the gesture-based game. Not only is the prospect of gaming exciting, but you are having fun while doing the exercise, to an extent where you completely forget the exercise part and concentrate more on completing the game.

Game Therapy is the discipline which incorporates regular games in the form of therapy. While it is being practised globally, in India it is still in its infancy. Though games can take many forms, we are primarily concerned with gesture-based games in general and the games using the Nintendo Wii in particular.



Elderly patients at a US hospital engaging in Wii gaming as part of therapy

help of the Nintendo Wii and its accessories, to assist in recovery of patients suffering from neurological or orthopaedic disorders. "Since Wii activities require both physical actions as well as cognitive

processes, the Wii can be used as a therapeutic tool to address most problems seen in rehab. A therapist may use Wii Tennis to help someone improve range of motion in the shoulder, use Wii Boxing to help someone

with Parkinson's disease increase their ability to move more rhythmically or use Wii Pose Me to improve critical thinking skills," says Dr. Mershon Hinkel, who has been an Occupational Therapist in the US for close to 25 years and conducts a workshop named *Using Nintendo Wii in a Therapeutic Setting* to educate OTs in using

Wii as an assistant to regular therapy. It's a big trend in the US, seemingly enough. The WiiFit Balance board received a lot of positive press when it launched back in 2008 and for good reason. Generally, gamers are known for being couch potatoes, but the whole idea of WiiFit is to make these gamers forget the controller and use their whole body while balancing on a board which communicates with the Wii console. The WiiFit comes with a range of games such as Yoga, Table Tilt and Skiing, which are fun ways to use your body to play the game. The graphics, game score and the competitive edge, keep the patient motivated to continue playing the game. Apart from the WiiFit, the Wii console itself has a range of sports games such as Wii Baseball, Wii tennis, etc., which involves physical movements that the player would do while actually playing the sport. For patients wanting to improve muscle co-ordination and muscle strength, these games are a great alternative to mere exercises. There have



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Goodbye Rehab; Hello Wiihab

Occupational Therapy (OT) is a branch of therapy concerned with promoting health and well-being through engagement in occupation. Wiihab is a blanket term used to describe the abundant use of interactive gesture-based games, primarily with the